

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



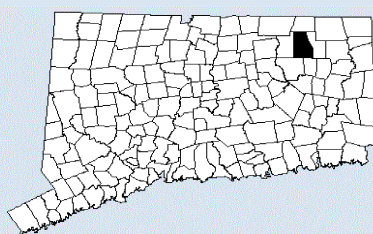
Ashford School District

Cynthia Ford, Superintendent • 860-429-1927 • <http://www.ashfordct.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	355
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$24,046
Total Expenditures ¹	\$9,017,154

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	164	46.2	48.3
Male	191	53.8	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	6	1.7	5.2
Black or African American	6	1.7	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	30	8.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	11	3.1	4.7
White	302	85.1	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	117	33.0	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	55	15.5	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	7	4.4	*	*
Male	21	12.4	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	19	6.9	8	2.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	14	13.1	*	*
Students with Disabilities	10	18.2	*	*
District	28	8.5	11	2.9
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	35.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	5.5
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	5.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	13.5
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.0
School Level	2.1
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	1.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	28.8

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	48	100.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	15.7	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	10	*
Other Health Impairment	*	*
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	9	*
District	26	60.5
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	8	2.5	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	17	5.2	6.4
Other Health Impairment	*	*	3.5
Other Disabilities	0	0.0	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	11	3.4	2.0
All Disabilities	45	13.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$5,773,163	\$15,395	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$485,968	\$1,324	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$283,611	\$773	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$298,317	\$813	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$504,532	\$1,375	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$445,751	\$1,215	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$862,416	\$2,350	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$363,396	\$990	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$9,017,154	\$24,046	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$349,239	17.0	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$411,163	20.0	10.2
Other Salaries	\$238,643	11.6	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$506,197	24.6	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$284,334	13.8	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$213,950	10.4	22.2
Supplies	\$32,408	1.6	0.7
Property Services	\$2,000	0.1	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.4
Equipment	\$20,410	1.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$389	0.0	0.1
Total	\$2,058,732	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		22.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	63.8
State	30.2
Federal	5.9
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	17	*	16	*	7	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	7	*	7	*	*	*
White	188	68.3	188	64.7	70	67.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	7	*	7	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	212	68.0	211	64.2	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	73	64.4	72	60.6	30	63.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	146	69.5	146	66.0	54	70.9
Students with Disabilities	38	51.3	37	44.2	15	*
Students without Disabilities	181	71.3	181	68.3	69	70.9
High Needs	97	60.4	96	55.6	42	61.2
Non-High Needs	122	73.7	122	71.0	42	75.0
District	219	67.8	218	64.2	84	68.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	40.5	38.1	42.5	N/A	119	40.3
Curl Up	97.4	95.2	95.0	N/A	120	95.8
Push Up	81.1	68.3	77.5	N/A	118	75.4
Mile Run/PACER	78.9	73.8	61.5	N/A	119	71.4
All Tests - District	29.7	26.8	28.2	N/A	117	28.2
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	67.8	75	45.2	50	90.4	63.9
	High Needs Students	60.4	75	40.3	50	80.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	64.2	75	42.8	50	85.6	60.2
	High Needs Students	55.6	75	37.0	50	74.1	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	68.1	75	45.4	50	90.8	61.8
	High Needs Students	61.2	75	40.8	50	81.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	53.6%	100%	53.6	100	53.6	58.7%
	High Needs Students	48.6%	100%	48.6	100	48.6	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	59.8%	100%	59.8	100	59.8	61.4%
	High Needs Students	54.1%	100%	54.1	100	54.1	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	8.5%	<=5%	42.9	50	85.9	17.7%
	High Needs Students	14.3%	<=5%	31.4	50	62.9	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		100.0%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.6% 28.2%	75%	18.8	50	37.6	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				610.8	900	67.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	73.7	60.4	13.3	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	71.0	55.6	15.5	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.2	13.8	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	98.1
Math	All Students	97.4
	High Needs Students	97.2
Science	All Students	96.7
	High Needs Students	97.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Ashford School provides its students a robust support system in remedial, intervention and special education including the addition of services for those students identified as gifted and/or talented.

There are full-time school social workers and a school counselor who work collaboratively with our teachers and with the Town's Youth Services Bureau; valuable attention, assistance and services are available to our students and their families.

With a very active PTO, School Readiness Council and parent volunteers, Ashford School is always integrated in the community. There are a range of activities held at Ashford School that reach the community. We observe Veteran's Day activities, house town recreation department activities, and as a fully integrated STEAM school, we host many curricular based and have adopted Project Based Learning and we are focusing on social literacy. We are committed to serving the full range of ability levels through a fully differentiated instructional model that meets students at their current ability and performance level and delivers individualized instruction for optimal advancement academically as well as social/emotionally.

Students have abundant access to technology. There are mobile laptop carts, classroom computers and iPads, an array of software, SmartBoards in classrooms and students in Grade 5 have 1:1 technology use.

With the support of the Ashford Board of Education, district improvement continues to move forward under a new school vision and mission statements. Monthly articles to the Ashford Citizen from the Superintendent and Ashford School keep the town informed of activities and events at Ashford School and weekly announcements are emailed to families every Friday. Special education at Ashford School reflects a comprehensive approach to educational programming, philosophy, design and services to best meet the individual for our students with disabilities while being integrated with the regular education population offering a full range of supports for students and their families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a rural school district, Ashford has a relatively low minority population and few English language learners. Efforts to increase school wide awareness of diversity among people have always been abundant at Ashford School.

Ashford is very involved with cultural activities including a student and teacher exchange with teachers and students from Germany to study education, economy and culture, we continue to partner with the Teachers of Critical Languages Program, sponsored by the Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs of the US Department of State. This will be our second year welcoming a teacher from Egypt. Ashford School is a participant of HOT Schools (Higher Order of Thinking). Students and staff benefit from culturally diverse and sensitive activities through HOT Schools.

Ashford School and the Town of Ashford have partnered together to pilot an after school care program for the 2023-2024 school year.

The Ashford PTO and cultural arts committee sponsor cultural arts assemblies throughout the school year.

There is an after-school program in place for students in grades 2-8. Other programs and activities include Positive Behavior Supports (PBIS), Primary Pride, STEAM events, regional athletic participation, robotics tournaments, Veteran's Day activities and music festival participation with other districts across the state. Ashford School, along with the Ashford Youth Service Bureau offer assistance to families that may face economic challenges through the annual Holiday Giving Tree and Thanksgiving Baskets programs.

We strive to teach our students tolerance of others, good citizenship and cultural and community awareness, and this will continue to be a priority for each and every student who passes through our doors.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

As a single school district educating students in grades PK-8, this item would not be applicable to our district as it relates to equitable sharing.